From sign-up to your first text in ~20 days

The five onboarding stages: who does what, and what to have ready so you go live faster.

Your Salesmessage onboarding runs in five stages, with a typical timeline of about 20 days to go live. One stage is the gate: carrier compliance. Getting us your business details early and accurately is the single biggest way to go live faster.

01

The gate: carrier approval

You can't send texts or calls until your business is registered and approved by the carriers (10DLC or Toll-Free). We prepare and submit it for you, but the carriers make the final call. That usually takes several business days, occasionally longer.

02

The five stages

1 · Welcome & kickoff	Day 0–3
2 · Compliance & registration	The gate: start here
3 · Account setup	Runs in parallel with compliance
4 · Training	Before launch
5 · Go-live & support	~Day 20+

03

Stage 1: Welcome & kickoff

What we do	Match you with an Onboarding Manager (and a CSM, depending on plan); run the kickoff call.
What you do	Bring points of contact, texting use case, user and number counts, tools, ideal live date.
Done when	You've had the kickoff and have your onboarding plan and timeline in writing.

04

Stage 2: Compliance & registration

What we do	Register you: 10DLC for local numbers, Toll-Free Verification for toll-free and all Canadian numbers.
We also	Prepare, submit and manage the whole review, and fix and resubmit anything returned.
What you do	Send us the checklist in section 08. Ask us to review your opt-in form before you submit.
Done when	Your Brand and Campaign are carrier-approved and sending is unlocked.

05

Stage 3: Account setup

What we do	Set up numbers and inboxes (new, transferred, ported or hosted), users, assignment rules, business hours.
We also	Configure roles and permissions, and connect your CRM and tools.
What you do	Confirm your user list, numbers and integrations: HubSpot, Aircall, RingCentral.
Done when	Numbers, users and integrations are live and a test message sends.

06

Stage 4: Training

What we do	A 1:1 admin session and a group session for your users.
Topics covered	1:1 texting, broadcasts, tags, contacts, calling, your CRM integration, SMS best practices.
What you do	Book the sessions and get your team on them. Weekly webinars and Help Center stay open.
Done when	Admins and users are trained and have the recording and recap.

07

Stage 5: Go-live & support

What we do	Check in the morning of go-live, then follow up about two weeks later.
Follow-up goal	Clear blockers and confirm the KPIs you're measuring.
What you do	Start texting, and bring anything you need to your Customer Success Manager.
Done when	You're live, measured, and on a regular check-in cadence.

08

Bring these to Stage 2

Have these ready and you'll clear the gate fast.

Legal name + EIN / Tax ID	Exactly as they appear on your IRS documents.
Active business website	With a Privacy Policy (including SMS consent language) and Terms.
Your opt-in method	A link or screenshot: web form, paper, keyword or QR.
Use case + sample messages	What you'll send, plus a couple of real examples with your brand name.
Users and numbers	Who needs access, and whether you're bringing existing numbers.
Your integrations	The CRM and tools you want connected.

09

A rejection isn't a dead end

If the carriers send something back, we tell you exactly what to change and resubmit it for you. The usual causes:

- A legal name that doesn't match IRS records.
- A brand-new EIN that hasn't propagated yet (30–90 days).
- An opt-in form that bundles all message types into one checkbox.

Not sure where you are?

Ask your Onboarding Manager or CSM which stage you're in. Send your opt-in form for a two-minute review.

Email support

support@salesmessage.com